

notes and videos that you can download for free. Check out Slideshare (<http://www.slideshare.net/>) and Slashdot (<http://slashdot.org/>). Slashdot has all the news to whet your appetite for all things geeky.

You need to complement your quest for knowledge by hanging out with people of your own kind. So you have to 'flock' with 'birds of the same feather'. Most programmers exchange ideas and post queries on the several Stack Exchange sites (<http://stackexchange.com/>). You'll be awarded points for accepting other people's answers for questions you have posted and answering other people's questions. You will most probably use two of the 100 odd sites out there – Server Fault (<http://serverfault.com/>) and Stack Overflow (<http://stackoverflow.com/>). So register yourself for a Stack Exchange account, earn points, badges and see your reputation grow. Some Web development companies rely on this reputation score while evaluating job applications.

Hasgeek (<https://hasgeek.com/>) provides online discussion spaces for geeks and even hosts events. You can learn new things on these channels or if you feel confident enough, participate in their 'hacknights'. By the way, they do have a job portal.

IBM Developer Works has several tutorials that

cover a broad technology landscape (<http://www.ibm.com/developerworks/>). The articles on the site come in bite sizes and do not overwhelm the reader. It's a good place to begin your quest for knowledge.

For the latest on hardware – yes hardware, because remember, you write your software to run on some hardware – visit <http://www.anandtech.com/>. AnandTech has a review on most hardware that hits the market.

The magazine you are reading has an annual conference for open source enthusiasts called OSI Days. It offers tremendous opportunities to hear eminent open source programmers talk about their technologies, platforms and work.

Most cities have several special interest groups – Bar Camps, the Drupal Community and Linux Users Groups are some of the most popular ones. Join the ones that you find exciting and interact with people, seek help with your code, share ideas and watch yourself grow. **END** 

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